



# MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



## SACRED TEXT

*adhanās traya evoktā bhāryā dāsas tathā sutaḥ | 05.039a*  
*yat te samadhigacchanti yasya te tasya tad dhanam || 39 || 05.039c*

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 5, Verse 1

## GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Nāradaśmṛti, in this verse, paints a picture of ownership and dependence, using stark terms that might feel jarring to modern sensibilities. It speaks of the wife, the servant, and the son as being without independent wealth, suggesting that whatever they acquire belongs to the head of the household. To understand this, we must consider the historical context of ancient India, where patriarchal structures and social hierarchies were deeply entrenched. The verse reflects a time when women and dependents often lacked legal rights and economic autonomy.

However, a spiritual interpretation transcends the literal and invites us to delve into the underlying principles. This verse can be seen as a metaphor for the interconnectedness of relationships and the responsibilities that come with them. It's not necessarily about absolute ownership but about the flow of resources and the recognition of shared destinies within a family unit. The “wealth” isn't simply monetary; it can represent skills, talents, and contributions made by each member, all ultimately benefiting the collective.

In modern life, this verse prompts us to examine our own relationships and the power dynamics within them. Are we truly valuing the contributions of everyone in our lives, regardless of their perceived status or role? Do we foster an environment where everyone feels empowered to contribute their unique gifts? It challenges us to move beyond a transactional mindset and cultivate a spirit of generosity and mutual support. The verse speaks to the responsibilities inherent in caregiving and leadership. As the head of a household, or in any position of influence, are you ensuring that those under your care have their needs met and are given opportunities to thrive? Are you empowering them to develop their own potential, or are you stifling their growth through control and possessiveness? Ultimately, this verse invites us to reflect on the nature of ownership itself. Do we truly own anything, or are we merely custodians of resources that are meant to be shared for the greater good?

## REFLECTION FOR TODAY

*How can you consciously shift power dynamics in your relationships to foster greater equity and mutual respect, honoring the inherent worth of everyone involved?*